Johannes le Roux. ENTREPRENEUR COACH

Claude for *entrepreneurs.*

The remote version. Your own time, your own laptop, one real thing at the end of it.

Inus Smuts

Creative Director · Platō Coffee Group

WHAT YOU'RE BRINGING

A Shopify site for a new brand — one of the group's, not Platō itself.

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Before you start

Twenty minutes of setup. Do it the night before rather than at the top of the session — the one thing that reliably ruins a solo run is spending the first hour on an account problem.

1. A PAID CLAUDE PLAN

About R400 a month, billed by Anthropic. Then install the **desktop app**, not just the browser — the file handling is better and you'll be moving files. If your card declines it's almost always your bank blocking the international payment; enable that in your banking app and try again.

2. ADD THE WORKSHOP SKILL

Download it, and **don't unzip it**:

https://github.com/getluckyjo/claudeworkshop/raw/HEAD/dist/entrepreneurcoach.zip

In Claude: click your name bottom-left → Settings → Customize → Skills → upload the zip. You'll know it worked when **Entrepreneur Coach** appears in your list. Then open a *new* chat and type *help me get set up* — skills don't load into a conversation that was already running.

3. HAVE YOUR MATERIAL TO HAND

- The new brand — name, what it is, who it's for, and how it's different from Platō. A paragraph is plenty; it doesn't need to be the finished positioning
- Your product list, however rough. Names, sizes, variants, prices, cost if you have it. A spreadsheet, a WhatsApp voice note transcribed, the back of an envelope — all fine
- Three or four things already written in the brand's voice. Even a packaging back-panel or a caption. This is the one that decides whether the output sounds like the brand or like a template
- Product photos, if they exist. Not required to start
- Your Platō copy, for contrast — so it can hear what to move away from

> **ONE RULE**
>
> You won't be asked to write code, open a terminal, or install anything beyond the app. If a step ever seems to need it, that means the session has taken a wrong turn — not that you've missed something. Mail me.

What you walk out with

Four things, running on your own machine. Not notes about how you might do it later.

1 **A Project that knows the brand**
Its documents, its rules, its voice — in one place that outlives the chat.

2 **One real artefact**
A file you can use, off your own product list.

3 **A skill that repeats it**
So the next one costs a fraction of the first.

4 **One job running on a schedule**
The first thing that happens without you.

BRIEFING, NOT PROMPTING

The single biggest difference between people who find this underwhelming and people who don't. A prompt asks for a thing. A brief says what you're trying to achieve and hands over what's needed to do it.

1. **The job.** What you want done, and why it matters.
2. **The context.** The brand, the constraints, the deadline.
3. **The material.** The real file. Not a description of it.
4. **What good looks like.** How you'd know it was done properly.
5. **The format.** A spreadsheet, a page, a document, a file.

Working alone, the failure mode is politeness. In a room I'd tell you to reject a bad answer out loud and say exactly what's wrong with it. On your own it's tempting to quietly fix it yourself and move on — which teaches it nothing, and you pay for the same flaw again on the next one. Say what's wrong. It's faster.

The launch, minus the typing

You already know what the brand is. What stands between you and live is a few thousand words of product copy, SEO fields and policy pages that nobody enjoys writing and everybody writes badly under deadline. That is the part we hand over — in the brand's voice, decided by you once and applied everywhere.

WHERE THE LINE ACTUALLY FALLS

It will not build the store. The theme, the payment setup, the domain and the navigation are yours to click through in the Shopify admin, and nothing here changes that.

Products are a different matter. There are two routes and the second one surprises people, so both are on the next page. Either way the work is the same — what differs is where it lands.

WHAT REPEATS AFTERWARDS

A brand voice skill, so product forty costs what product one did. Then the same skill writes the launch emails, the collection descriptions and the social captions without being re-briefed each time.

WATCH FOR

Two things will try to eat your afternoon. The first is the store itself — the theme, the fonts, the hero image. You're a creative director; that pull is real and it is not what this session is for. The second is doing the range before the voice. Both roads end with forty products that read like a template, and re-doing them costs more than doing them slowly once.

Two ways in. Pick before you start.

Getting products into Shopify takes minutes on either route. Writing forty product descriptions that sound like the brand takes an afternoon on both. So choose on what you want between the writing and the shop floor, not on which sounds more advanced.

1 A file you import

It builds a product CSV — titles, descriptions, SEO fields, tags, variants, alt text. You open it, read it, fix what you don't like, then Shopify → Products → Import.

Nothing needed beyond Claude. The spreadsheet is a review gate: forty descriptions in front of you before a single one exists in a store carrying the group's name. **This is the one I'd use for a launch**, and it's what the five steps assume.

2 Straight into the store

Claude connects to the Shopify Admin API and creates the products itself — and can then edit them, set inventory and read orders on request.

Real, and worth knowing about. Two caveats. Shopify's own MCP servers don't do this — Storefront and Checkout are shopper-facing and the Dev one is documentation and code validation for engineers — so product writing means a third-party connector plus an Admin API token you generate from a custom app in Shopify admin. That token is group infrastructure, so it's a conversation with whoever owns your Shopify org, not a decision for a Saturday. And there is no spreadsheet in the middle: what it writes is what's in the store.

Do the launch on the CSV. Once the voice skill exists and you trust what comes out of it, the connector is the obvious next step for the month-after work — adding a line, a seasonal range, a price change across forty SKUs. Earn it on the first route first.

The five steps

Do them in order. Step 1 looks like the soft one and it is the one everything else rests on — skip it and steps 2 to 5 produce competent copy for a brand that could be anyone's. Each grey box is what to ask. Allow about three hours, or three sittings of an hour.

1 Write the voice down first

> “Here's the new brand — what it is, who it's for, how it differs from Platō. Here are four things already written in its voice, and here's some Platō copy for contrast. Interview me until you could write as this brand yourself.”

Let it ask questions and answer them properly. When it thinks it has the voice, make it prove it: give it a product it has never seen and ask for fifty words. If that comes back sounding like the brand, you have something. If it comes back sounding like a coffee brand, keep going — that's the gap you're paid to close.

2 One product, argued over

> “Take one product from my list. Write the title, the description, the SEO title and meta description, the tags, and the image alt text. Show me your reasoning on the title.”

Push back on this one until it's genuinely right — you're not reviewing a product, you're setting the pattern the other thirty-nine inherit. Ten minutes here saves an afternoon of fixing the same flaw forty times.

3 The whole range, as a file Shopify eats

> “Now do the rest of the range the same way, and give me a Shopify product import CSV — Handle, Title, Body (HTML), Vendor, Type, Tags, Published, Option1 Name, Option1 Value, Variant SKU, Variant Price, Variant Inventory Qty, Image Src, Image Alt Text, SEO Title, SEO Description, Status.”

Shopify → Products → Import takes that file directly. Import into a *development* store first, or tick nothing as published — either way you look at it in the admin before it can be seen. Expect to reject a few. Reject them out loud and say why, so the fix carries.

4 The pages nobody wants to write

> “Same voice: the About page, shipping, returns, FAQ, and the three-email welcome flow for someone who has just bought for the first time.”

Give it your real terms — actual delivery times, the real returns window, what happens if a bag arrives damaged. Invented policy is a legal problem, not a copy problem, and it will invent cheerfully if you leave a gap.

5 Make it repeat

> “That worked. Write it up as a skill so I can add a product next month without explaining the brand again.”

This is the step that turns three hours into an asset. Name it after the brand, not after Platō — you'll launch another one, and the voice should travel with the brand it belongs to.

Before you finish

Most training evaporates inside a fortnight, and solo runs evaporate faster because nobody asks you about it on the Monday. This is the page that decides whether yours does.

THE BRAND'S VOICE, IN ONE SENTENCE I'D DEFEND IN A MEETING

WHAT I BUILT, AND WHERE IT LIVES

WHAT BROKE, OR CAME BACK WRONG — THE USEFUL LIST

THE ONE THING I'LL DO BY FRIDAY

THEN

You're doing this without me in the room, so one ask: when you hit something that doesn't work, write down what you asked and what came back before you work around it. That list is worth more to the next version of this than anything that went smoothly.

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